

LEADING EXPERTS

Leading is not having the technical answer.

How to lead the expert without pretending you understand.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

It is making sure the decision gets made, with someone carrying the consequence.

THE CASCADE

The two paths that both go wrong.

WHAT YOU SEE

Either you fake mastery, and she spots it in the first meeting...

THE MECHANISM

...or you vanish from the decision and rubber stamp whatever she brings...

THE CONSEQUENCE

...and either way the team drifts.

Experts do not respect who knows more, they respect who plays the role.

THE FORK

Whose decision is this, after all.

WHOSE CALL IS IT

01

Is it about how to do it? Hers, and you stay out.

02

Is it about time, cost, client or risk? Yours.

03

Is it about what comes first? Yours, with her analysis.

Deciding is not knowing more. It is carrying the consequence.

THE METHOD

The Translator's Role, four moves.

01 **ASK**

to understand for real, never to test the other person

02 **TRANSLATE**

turn the technical answer into business impact

03 **DECIDE**

own the choice that is not technical, and sign it

04 **SHIELD**

give her the stage and absorb the pressure
from outside

None of these four requires you to master the craft.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

What to say when you do not know the answer.

01 • ASK

What would you do in my seat?

pulls her out of the detail and into the decision context

02 • TRANSLATE

What risk am I not seeing?

the answer is usually worth more than the original proposal

03 • DECIDE

What do we lose if we take the other path?

forces a comparison, and comparison is business language

04 • SHIELD

What do you need from me?

here is where the blocker only you can remove shows up

TWO MODELS

Competing with the expert or leading the expert.

THE COMMON MODEL

Competing

Weighs in on the how to look present

Hides what was not understood

Takes credit for the solution

Vanishes when the call is hard

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Leading

Sets the what and the why

Asks in front of everyone

Gives the stage to whoever solved it

Signs the hard decision

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three things an expert does not forgive.

01 Using memorized jargon to pass as a technical peer.

- she spots it in seconds, and the trust does not come back easily.
-

02 Downgrading her solution in front of another team.

- next time she brings the minimum, and you never hear the rest.
-

03 Asking for an opinion and deciding with no explanation.

- consulting with no feedback teaches the team to stop weighing in.
-

You do not need to win the technical argument. You need to close the decision.

THE CHAIN

The hard meeting test.

01

The board questions your team's technical choice.



02

You pass the question along and watch her defend it alone.



03

Or you explain the decision as yours, and that is leading.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

The expert holds up the argument. You hold up the decision.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Three moves for the next conversation.



STEP 01

Use one of the four questions in the next technical meeting.

and resist the urge to finish her sentence



STEP 02

Ask for the translation into one business sentence.

what this changes in time, cost, risk or client



STEP 03

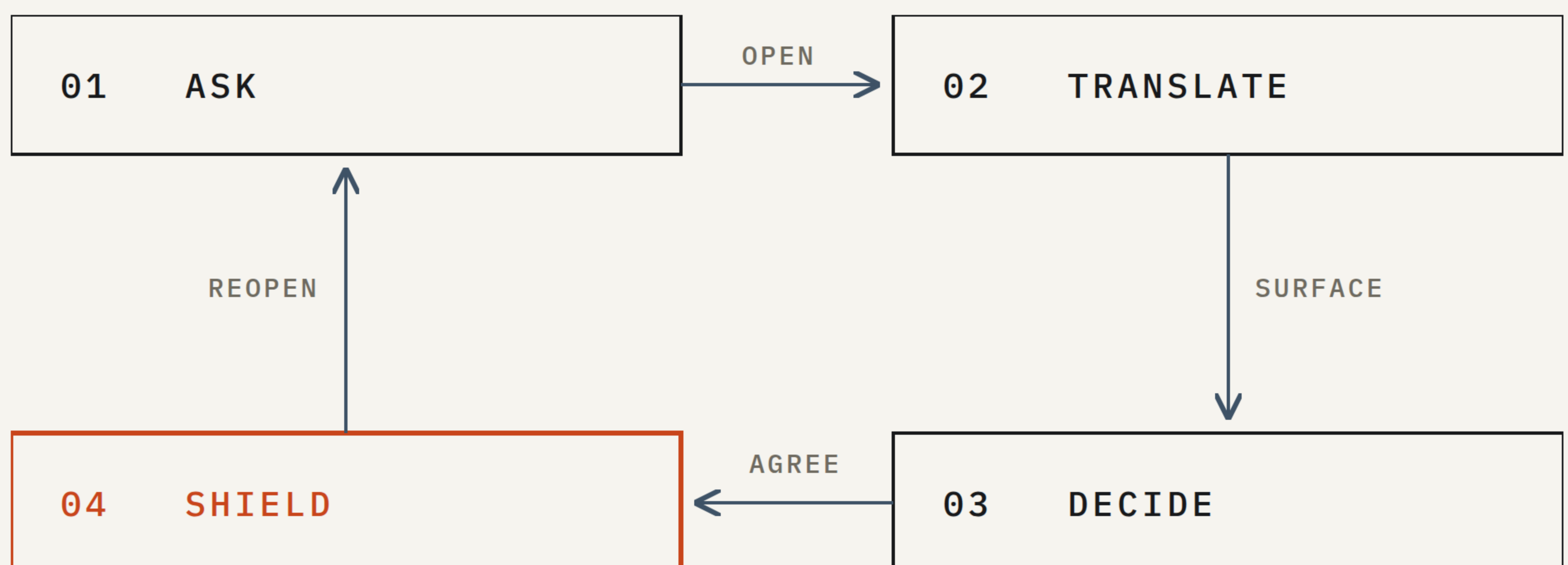
Say her name when you present the result upward.

credit given in public comes back as double the delivery

Good leadership does not control knowledge, it releases talent.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Translator, a loop and not a list.



Leading someone who knows more is not competing. It is translating, deciding and protecting.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

in the next meeting where you are the least technical person in the room.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA